



DC – AI – Routing – Switching – Security – Wireless – Automation

Creating Audit Trails with the Apstra Event Log

An HPE Juniper Networking Techpost

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HPE



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1 Creating Audit Trails with the Apstra Event Log

Bill Wester - 08/16/2023

The Audit trail feature tracks a user's actions while using Apstra and can be very useful in investigating general usage, network outages, and possible suspicious activity.

1.1 Introduction

Juniper Apstra automates the creation and management of data center fabrics and is designed to be the central point from which all network changes are made.

1.2 What is Audited?

Each of the following is modeled as an audit event within Apstra.

- Login and Logout: including failed login attempts
- Blueprint Commits: changes committed from staged to active blueprint
- Blueprint Reverts: discards changes in the staged blueprint
- Blueprint Deletes: removing an entire blueprint
- Per device config change attributed to the user: This includes any config change that Apstra pushes to any managed device (including Time Voyager). The audit event is attributed to the logged-in user making the change.

1.3 View Audit Logs (Event Log)

1. The Event Logs can be accessed from the Apstra UI - Platform>Event Log, as seen in the screenshot below.

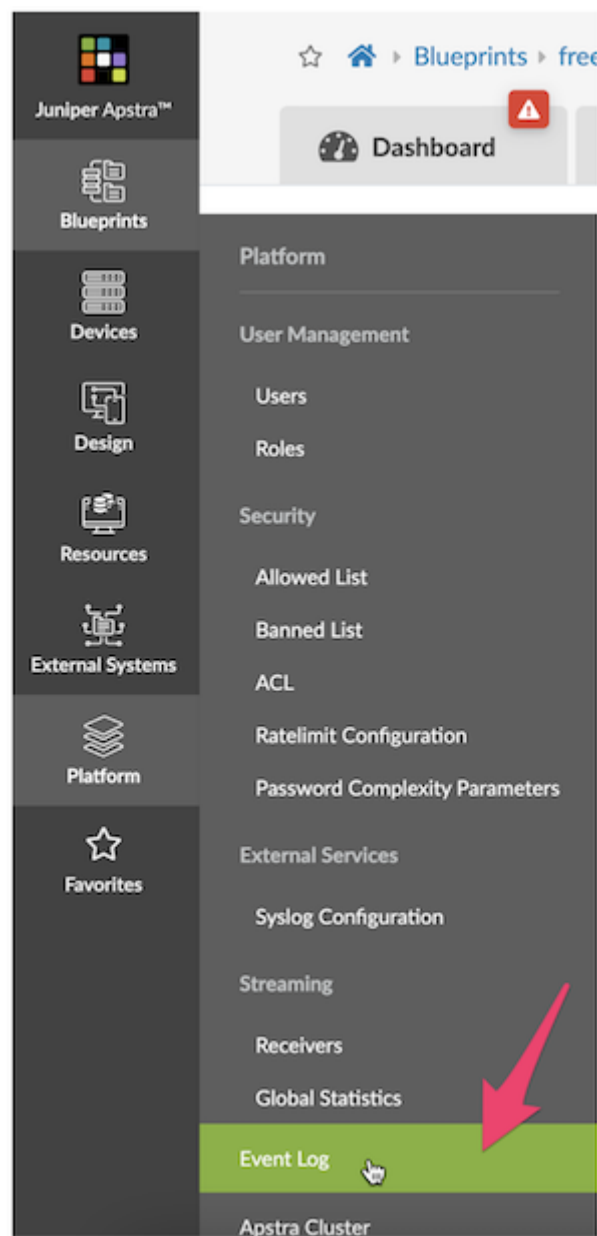
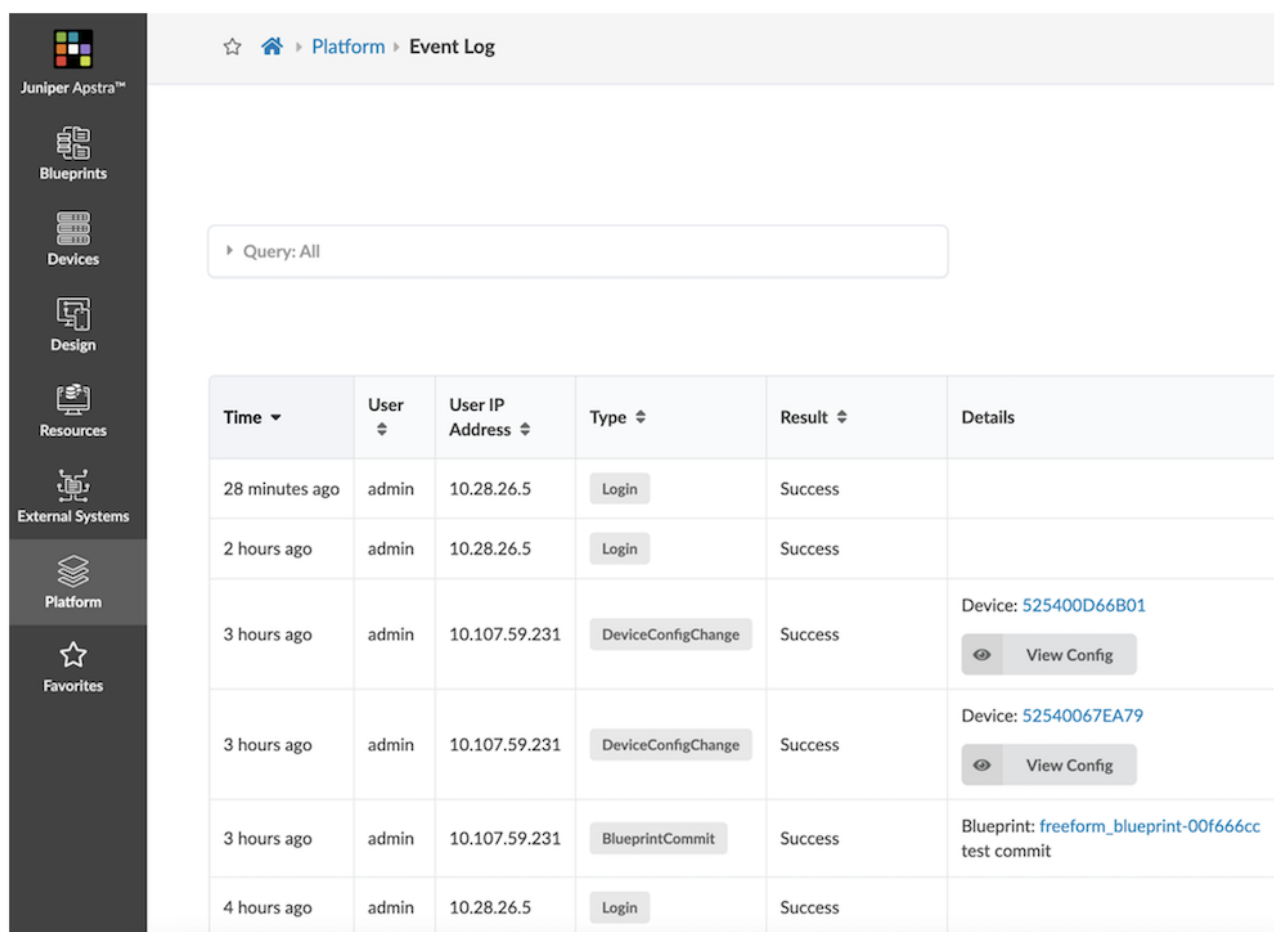


Figure 1: Audit-Trails-01

2. This view Displays the most recent 25 events in a table. You can change the page size of this table like any other table.

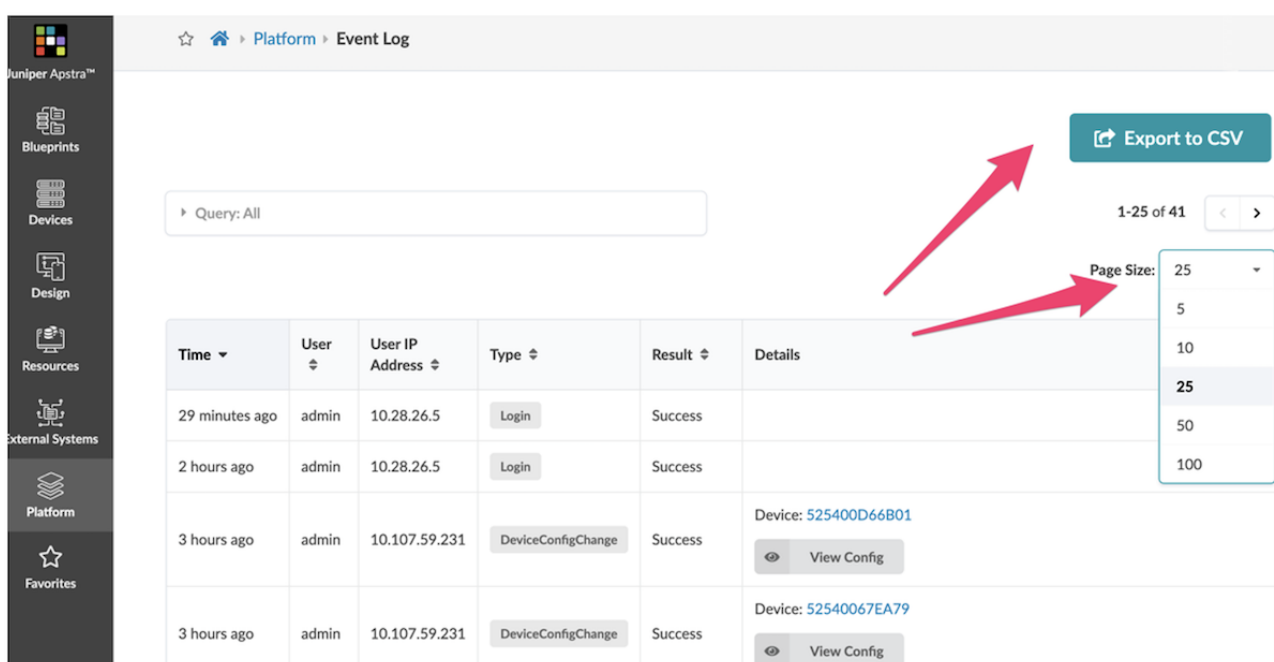


The screenshot shows the Juniper Apstra Platform Event Log interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation icons for Blueprints, Devices, Design, Resources, External Systems, Platform (selected), and Favorites. The main area has a breadcrumb trail 'Platform > Event Log' and a search bar with 'Query: All'. Below is a table of events.

Time	User	User IP Address	Type	Result	Details
28 minutes ago	admin	10.28.26.5	Login	Success	
2 hours ago	admin	10.28.26.5	Login	Success	
3 hours ago	admin	10.107.59.231	DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 525400D66B01 View Config
3 hours ago	admin	10.107.59.231	DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 52540067EA79 View Config
3 hours ago	admin	10.107.59.231	BlueprintCommit	Success	Blueprint: freeform_blueprint-00f666cc test commit
4 hours ago	admin	10.28.26.5	Login	Success	

Figure 2: Audit-Trails-02

3. You can click on paging controls to see additional pages.



This screenshot shows the same interface as Figure 2, but with additional UI elements highlighted. A red arrow points to the 'Export to CSV' button in the top right. Another red arrow points to the 'Page Size' dropdown menu, which is currently set to 25. The table shows the first few rows of the event log.

Time	User	User IP Address	Type	Result	Details
29 minutes ago	admin	10.28.26.5	Login	Success	
2 hours ago	admin	10.28.26.5	Login	Success	
3 hours ago	admin	10.107.59.231	DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 525400D66B01 View Config
3 hours ago	admin	10.107.59.231	DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 52540067EA79 View Config

Figure 3: Audit-Trails-03

4. You can export the logs to a CSV file by clicking the “Export to CSV” button.

1.4 Searching Audit Logs

Logs over time fill with many events, which can mask the one you want to see. Apstra provides a query function via the UI or the Rest API, allowing you to search for that important event previously masked or hidden within this log file.

1. Click on “Query: All,” as shown below.
2. You can search on audit logs by following criteria (any combination is possible, choosing multiple fields returns audit events that match criteria for all fields).
 - a. User
 - b. User IP Address
 - c. Source IP
 - d. Type
 - e. Blueprint Name
 - f. Device Key
 - g. Result
 - h. Time Range
 - i. Blueprint Commit Message

▼ Query: All

User

User IP Address

Type

Blueprint Name

Device Key

Result

Time Range

Start time

End time

Blueprint Commit Message

Q Apply

↺ Clear

1.5 Search Examples

View all config changes in the past five days

☆ 🏠 > Platform > Event Log

▼ Query: Type = DeviceConfigChange and Time Range = Feb 16, 2023 00:00 – Feb 22, 2023 00:00

User

User IP Address

Type
DeviceConfigChange ✕ ▼

Blueprint Name

Device Key

Result

Time Range
Feb 16, 2023 00:00 ✕ Feb 22, 2023 00:00 ✕

Blueprint Commit Message

🔍 Apply 🔄 Clear

Figure 4: Audit-Trails-05

☆ 🏠 > Platform > Event Log

Query: Type = DeviceConfigChange and Time Range = Feb 16, 2023 00:00 – Feb 22, 2023 00:00

Export to CSV

1-12 of 12 < >

Page Size: 25

Can export to CSV

12 changes match search

Time ▾	User ⚙	User IP Address ⚙	Type ⚙	Result ⚙	Details
a day ago	system		DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 5254009D444C View Config
a day ago	system		DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 525400C2F824 View Config
a day ago	system		DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 5254007878E2 View Config
a day ago	system		DeviceConfigChange	Success	Device: 525400D66B01 View Config

Figure 5: Audit-Trails-06

Failed user logins

▼ Query: Device Key = Failure: invalid password

User

User IP Address

Type

Blueprint Name

Device Key

Result

Failure: invalidpassword

Time Range

Start time

End time

Blueprint Commit Message

Apply

Clear

Figure 6: Audit-Trails-07

Query: Result = Failure: invalid password

1-8 of 8

< >

Page Size: 25

Export to CSV

8 Failed Logins

Time ▼	User ↕	User IP Address ↕	Type ↕	Result ↕	Details
2 hours ago	istacey	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	
2 hours ago	istacey	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	
2 hours ago	istacey	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	
2 hours ago	istacey	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	
3 days ago	istacey	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	
4 days ago	admin	88.202.202.213	Login	Failure: invalid password	

Figure 7: Audit-Trails-08

1.6 Audit Log Forwarding via Syslog

As well as viewing the log file via the UI, the log messages can also be sent to an external Syslog server.

1.6.1 Enabling Syslog Server in Apstra UI

Navigate to Platform>Syslog Configuration:

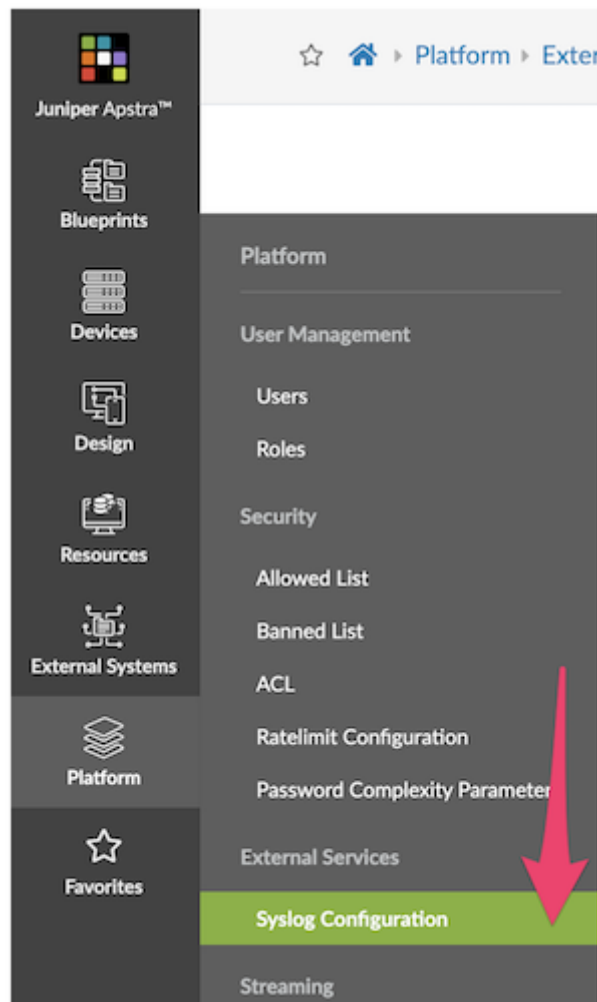


Figure 8: Audit-Trails-09

Options:

1. Transport protocol (TCP or UDP)
2. Remote Syslog IP address
3. Remote syslog port
4. The facility which will be assigned to forwarded log messages
5. Enable Forwarding Audit Logs
6. Enable Forwarding Anomalies

1.6.2 Forwarding Audit Logs: What is Audited?

- User login, logout
- Blueprint commits that push changes from staged to active blueprint
- Blueprint reverts that discard changes in the staged blueprint
- Blueprint deletes
- Per device config change attributed to the user. This includes any config change that Apstra pushes ever to any managed device. The audit event is attributed to the most appropriate user, and if not determinable, 'system' is specified as a user.

[+ Create Syslog Config](#)

1 of 1 < > Page Size: 25 ▼

IP Address and Port ▲	Protocol ⚙	Facility ⚙	Use for Audit ⚙	Forward Anomalies ⚙	Actions
100.81.5.7:514	UDP	local2	☒	☒	✎ 🖨 🗑

Figure 9: Audit-Trails-10

1.7 How to Parse Apstra Logs

Apstra uses the Common Event Format (CEF), a standard for the interoperability of event or log-generating devices and applications. The standard defines a syntax for log records. It comprises a standard prefix and a variable extension formatted as key-value pairs.

1.7.1 Apstra Log Format

'{timestamp} {host}' ** 'CEF:{version}|{device_vendor}|{device_product}|{device_version}|' '{device_event_class_id}|{name}|{severity}|{extension}'**

Where:

- version is always "0"
- device_vendor is always "Apstra"
- device_product is always "Apstra"
- device_version is the current Apstra version
- device_event_class_id is "100" for audit logs and "101" for anomaly logs
- name is always "Audit even" for audit logs and "Alert" for anomaly logs
- severity is always "medium" for audit logs and "Very-High" for anomaly logs

And where:

- {extension} is either:

For anomaly logs: msg=

For audit logs: cat= src= suser= act= cs1Label= cs1= cs2Label= cs2= cs3Label= cs2=

1.7.2 Audit Log Fields Table

Field	Description	Applies to
cat	Activity performed. Valid values: "Login", "Logout", "BlueprintCommit", "DeviceConfigChange", "BlueprintDelete".	All messages
src	Source IP of the client making HTTP requests	All messages
suser	Who performed the activity	All messages
act	Outcome of the activity - free-form string. "Success" means operation is accepted by system. In case of error, include error string. Ex: Unauthorized	All messages
cs1Label	The string "Blueprint Name"	Cat = "BlueprintCommit" or "BlueprintDelete"
cs1	Name of the blueprint on which action was taken.	Cat = "BlueprintCommit" or "BlueprintDelete"
cs2Label	The string "Blueprint ID"	Cat = "BlueprintCommit" or "BlueprintDelete"
cs2	Id of the blueprint on which action was taken.	Cat = "BlueprintCommit" or "BlueprintDelete"
cs3Label	The string "Commit Message". Only exists if user has added a commit message (optional)	Cat = "BlueprintCommit" or "BlueprintDelete"
cs3	Commit Message. Only exists if user has added a commit message (optional)	Cat = "BlueprintCommit"
deviceExternalId	Id (typically serial number) of the managed device on which action was taken.	Cat = "DeviceConfigChange"
deviceConfig	Config that is pushed and applied on the device where "#012" is used to indicate a line break to log collectors and parsers.	Cat = "DeviceConfigChange"

Audit Logs Extension Format

1.7.3 Anomalies JSON Fields Table

Field	Description	Applies to
u'blueprint_label'	String. Name of the blueprint the anomaly was raised in.	All messages
u'timestamp'	String. Name of the blueprint the anomaly was raised in.	All messages
u'origin_name'	String. Name of the blueprint the anomaly was raised in.	All messages
u>alert'	The value is a JSON Payload with the actual anomaly (see next table)	
u'origin_hostname'	String. Hostname of the device the anomaly affects.	All messages
u'device_hostname'	String. Hostname of the device the anomaly affects.	All messages
u'origin_role	String. Hostname of the device the anomaly affects.	All messages

Main Msg Format

Field	Description	Applies to
u'first_seen'	String. Unix timestamp when the Anomaly was raised for the first time.	All messages
u'raised'	Always True	All messages
u'severity	The severity level of the anomaly. In Apstra today, all anomalies are raised with severity level 3.	All messages

Alert Format

1.8 Anomaly Log Examples

1.8.1 IBA Anomaly “MLAG Anomaly”

The device_event_class_id = 101 for all anomalies

```

1 06 04 2020 08:42:50 10.23.59.188 <SLOG:INFO> 1 2020-06-04T13:26:54.195385Z aos-server - - -
2020-06-04T13:26:54.194168+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra|3.2.2-12|101|Alert|Very-High|
msg={u'blueprint_label': u'LAB', u'timestamp': 1591277214194168, u'origin_name': u'
FD021260P7L', u'alert': {u'first_seen': 1591277214194141, u'raised': True, u'severity': 3, u'
mlag_alert': {u'peer_link_status': u'down', u'actual_domain_state': 1, u'mlag_id': 0, u'
expected_intf_state': 0, u'hostname': u'USDAL1-LAB93108-LF1', u'peer_link': u'port-channel3
', u'expected_peer_link_status': u'up', u'actual_intf_state': 0, u'expected_domain_state':
4, u'ifname': u'', u'domain_id': u'1'}, u'id': u'6656a961-3139-4825-b89d-93f071271891'}, u'
origin_hostname': u'LAB1_HOST1', 'device_hostname': 'LAB1_HOST1', u'origin_role': u'leaf'}

```

1.8.2 IBA Anomaly “Unexpected Hostname”

```

1 Jun 8 21:35:25 aos-server - 2020-06-08T21:35:25.757009+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|101|Alert|Very-High|msg={u'blueprint_label': u'test', u'timestamp':
1591652125757009, u'origin_name': u'505400C5CAAA', u'alert': {u'first_seen':
1591652125757001, u'raised': True, u'severity': 3, u'hostname_alert': {u'expected_hostname':
u'sp1n1', u'actual_hostname': u'localhost'}, u'id': u'7f693f1d-2aeb-44a4-93f1-656400cfff7e
'}, u'origin_hostname': u'localhost', 'device_hostname': 'localhost', u'origin_role': u''}

```

1.8.3 User Logout and Logging

The device_event_class_id = 100 for all events

```

1 Jun 8 19:43:33 aos-server - 2020-06-08T19:43:33.392984+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|100|Audit event|medium|cat=Logout src=10.1.253.6 suser=admin act=Success
2 Jun 8 19:43:39 aos-server - 2020-06-08T19:43:39.267262+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|100|Audit event|medium|cat=Login src=10.1.253.6 suser=admin act=Success

```

1.8.4 Blueprint Delete

```

1 Jun 8 21:23:41 aos-server - 2020-06-08T21:23:41.426107+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|100|Audit event|medium|cat=BlueprintDelete src=10.1.253.6 suser=admin act=Success
cs1Label=Blueprint Name cs1=test cs2Label=Blueprint ID cs2=2bd8f38f-9242-461c-855e-8146
a4f68bb9

```

1.8.5 Blueprint Commit

```

1 Jun 8 21:42:19 aos-server - 2020-06-08T21:42:19.550216+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|100|Audit event|medium|cat=BlueprintCommit src=10.1.253.6 suser=admin act=Success
cs1Label=Blueprint Name cs1=test cs2Label=Blueprint ID cs2=5ba55c14-6c01-4537-9dd7-
d32c8c41616b cs3Label=Commit Message cs3=New_Virtual_Network

```

1.8.6 Device Config Change

Revert a full day-0 BP deployment

```

1 Jun 8 21:35:27 aos-server - 2020-06-08T21:35:27.132831+0000 aos-server CEF:0|Apstra|Apstra
|3.3.0-299|100|Audit event|medium|cat=DeviceConfigChange src=10.1.253.6 suser=admin act=
Success deviceExternalId=505400C5CAAA deviceConfig=
2 ...
3 <Device Config, see next table>
4 ...

```

1.8.7 Device Config

Note that “#012” is used to indicate a line break

```

1 service interface inactive expose#012!#012spanning-tree mode none#012!#012hostname spine1#012
  interface Ethernet1#012 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-001-leaf1:Ethernet1#012 no
  switchport#012 ip address 203.0.113.4/31#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012
2 interface Ethernet2#012 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-002-leaf1:Ethernet1/1#012 no
  switchport#012 ip address 203.0.113.6/31#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012interface
  Ethernet3#012 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-003-leaf1:Ethernet1/1#012 no switchport#012
3 ip address 203.0.113.8/31#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012interface Ethernet4#012 description
  facing_l2-virtual-ext-004-leaf1:Ethernet1#012 no switchport#012 ip address
  203.0.113.10/31#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012interface Ethernet5#012 no switchport#012
  no shutdown#012
4 exit#012!#012interface Ethernet6#012 no switchport#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012interface
  Ethernet7#012 no switchport#012 no shutdown#012 exit#012!#012ip routing#012!#012service
  routing protocols model multi-agent#012interface loopback 0#012 ip address
  203.0.113.20/32#012
5 exit#012!#012ip prefix-list AllPodNetworks seq 5 permit 0.0.0.0/0 le 32#012ip as-path access-
  list MyASN permit ^$#012route-map AllPodNetworks permit 10#012 match ip address prefix-list
  AllPodNetworks#012 exit#012!#012route-map EVPN permit 10#012 set ip next-hop unchanged#012
6 exit#012!#012router bgp 4200000000#012 router-id 203.0.113.20#012 no bgp default ipv4-unicast
  #012 bgp log-neighbor-changes#012 bgp bestpath as-path multipath-relax#012 redistribute
  connected route-map AllPodNetworks#012!#012 neighbor l3clos-s peer-group#012 neighbor l3clos
  -s timers 1 3#012
7 neighbor l3clos-s soft-reconfiguration inbound#012 neighbor l3clos-s maximum-routes 0 warning-
  limit 90 percent#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn peer-group#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn ebgp-
  multihop 2#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn timers 1 3#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn send-community
  extended#012
8 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn soft-reconfiguration inbound#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn update-source
  loopback0#012 neighbor l3clos-s-evpn maximum-routes 0 warning-limit 90 percent#012!#012!#012
  neighbor 203.0.113.0 remote-as 64512#012 neighbor 203.0.113.0 peer-group l3clos-s-evpn#012
9 neighbor 203.0.113.0 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-001-leaf1-evpn-overlay#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.5 remote-as 64512#012 neighbor 203.0.113.5 peer-group l3clos-s#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.5 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-001-leaf1#012 neighbor 203.0.113.1 remote-as
  64513#012
10 neighbor 203.0.113.1 peer-group l3clos-s-evpn#012 neighbor 203.0.113.1 description facing_l2-
  virtual-ext-002-leaf1-evpn-overlay#012 neighbor 203.0.113.7 remote-as 64513#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.7 peer-group l3clos-s#012 neighbor 203.0.113.7 description facing_l2-virtual-ext
  -002-leaf1#012
11 neighbor 203.0.113.2 remote-as 64514#012 neighbor 203.0.113.2 peer-group l3clos-s-evpn#012
  neighbor 203.0.113.2 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-003-leaf1-evpn-overlay#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.9 remote-as 64514#012 neighbor 203.0.113.9 peer-group l3clos-s#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.9 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-003-leaf1#012 neighbor 203.0.113.3 remote-as
  64515#012 neighbor 203.0.113.3 peer-group l3clos-s-evpn#012 neighbor 203.0.113.3 description
  facing_l2-virtual-ext-004-leaf1-evpn-overlay#012
12 neighbor 203.0.113.11 remote-as 64515#012 neighbor 203.0.113.11 peer-group l3clos-s#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.11 description facing_l2-virtual-ext-004-leaf1#012 address-family evpn#012
  neighbor l3clos-s-evpn route-map EVPN out#012 neighbor 203.0.113.0 activate#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.1 activate#012
13 neighbor 203.0.113.2 activate#012 neighbor 203.0.113.3 activate#012 exit#012 address-family ipv4
  #012 neighbor 203.0.113.11 activate#012 neighbor 203.0.113.5 activate#012 neighbor
  203.0.113.7 activate#012 neighbor 203.0.113.9 activate#012 exit#012 maximum-paths 32#012
  exit#012

```

1.9 Summary

As this paper demonstrates, Juniper Apstra Event Log facility is used for creating audit trails. Its extensive search and parsing capabilities allow you to zero in on the specific log entries you need.

1.10 Useful links

- Apstra User Guide: <https://www.juniper.net/documentation/us/en/software/apstra4.1/apstra-user-guide/index.html>

1.11 Glossary

- API: Application Programming Interface
- CEF: Common event Format, currently CEFv25

- CSV: Comma-Separated Values
- IP: Internet Protocol
- REST API: Representational State Transfer Application Programming Interface
- Syslog: A standardized system logging server
- TCP: Transmission Control Protocol
- UDP: User Datagram Protocol
- UI: User Interface



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